



LAKEWOOD CITY COUNCIL MINUTES

Monday, February 2, 2026

City of Lakewood

6000 Main Street SW

Lakewood, WA 98499

<https://us02web.zoom.us/j/86872632373>

Dial +1(253) 215- 8782 Participant ID: 868 7263 2373

CALL TO ORDER

Mayor Bocchi called the meeting to order at 7:00 p.m.

ROLL CALL

Councilmembers Present: 7 – Mayor Paul Bocchi, Deputy Mayor Patti Belle, Councilmembers Ellen Talbo, Michael Brandstetter, Philip Lindholm, Ryan Pearson and J. Trestin Lauricella.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

Mayor Bocchi led the Pledge of Allegiance.

PROCLAMATIONS AND PRESENTATIONS

Proclamation declaring February, 2026 as Black History Month.

DEPUTY MAYOR PATTI BELLE PRESENTED A PROCLAMATION RECOGNIZING FEBRUARY, 2026 AS BLACK HISTORY MONTH TO KIMI IRENE GINN, VIBRANT SCHOOLS OF PUGET SOUND.

Youth Council Report.

None.

PUBLIC COMMENTS

The City Council received written comments in advance of the meeting from Fred Feller, Virginia Jones and Kim Underwood.

Fred Feller, Lakewood resident, shared that the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints is coordinating a forty-thousand-pound food drive on February 26th at Emergency Food Network in honor of the 250th anniversary of the signing of the Declaration of Independence.

Paul Brice, Social Equity Task Force for Cannabis, spoke in support of access to cannabis in the City of Lakewood.

Mark Pfeiffer, Lakewood resident, spoke in support of the City Council increasing their engagement with citizens.

Christina Manetti, Garry Oak Coalition, spoke in support of denying the request to remove a 60 inch Oak tree at the Emerson Lake wetland area and in support of preservation and protection.

Christina Manetti, Lakewood resident, spoke in support of environmental protections of Garry Oak trees specifically the denial of cutting Oak tree near Emerson Lake.

Haley Ivey, Lakewood resident, spoke in support of environmental protection of trees and wetlands and the denial cutting the tree near the Emerson Lake property.

Helen Wagner, Lakewood resident, spoke in support of the preservation of Garry Oak trees.

Ebrahim Mirjalili, Lakewood resident, congratulated the City Council on their elections and spoke in support of justice.

Cathie Urwin, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the cutting of the Garry Oak Tree on the Emerson Lake property.

James Dunlop, Lakewood resident, spoke in support of tree preservation and in opposition the cutting of the Garry Oak tree on the Emerson Lake property.

Ginny Jones, spoke about U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) and the city's response.

Pepper Lisowska, Los Angeles, California, spoke in support of tree preservation and environmental protections and in opposition to the diesel log development.

Kim Underwood, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the Emerson Lake project and in support of environmental protections.

C O N S E N T A G E N D A

- A. Approval of the minutes of the City Council study session of January 12, 2026.
- B. Approval of the minutes of the City Council meeting of January 20, 2026.

C. Approval of claims vouchers, in the amount of \$8,047,944.68, for the period of December 16, 2025 through January 15, 2026.

D. Approval of payroll checks, in the amount of \$3,360,029.48, for the period of December 16, 2025 through January 15, 2026.

E. Motion No. 2026-10

Authorizing the execution of an agreement with Premier Electrical Contractors, in the amount of \$350,000, for the 2026 Electrical Services project.

F. Motion No. 2026-11

Appointing Katie Crook to serve on the Planning Commission through December 15, 2026.

G. Items filed in the Office of the City Clerk:

1. Community Services Advisory Board meeting minutes of November 20, 2025.
2. Parks and Recreation Advisory Board meeting minutes of November 25, 2025.
3. Planning Commission meeting minutes of January 7, 2026.

Councilmember Brandstetter requested Item No. F be removed from the Consent Agenda.

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVED TO ADOPT THE CONSENT AGENDA, MINUS ITEM NO. F, MOTION NO. 2026-11. SECONDED BY DEPUTY MAYOR BELLE. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER MOVED TO ADOPT MOTION NO. 2026-11. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER LAURICELLA. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

R E G U L A R A G E N D A

PUBLIC HEARINGS AND APPEALS

This is the date set for a public hearing on Lakewood Municipal Code amendments updating the allowed locations of alcohol productions and sales and related regulations.

Speaking before Council were:

Ebrahim Mirjalili, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition.

The public hearing was declared closed at 8:04 p.m.

ORDINANCE

Ordinance No. 843 Relating to contracting indebtedness; providing for the issuance, sale and delivery of not to exceed \$2,900,000 aggregate principal amount of limited tax general obligation refunding bonds to provide funds to prepay certain of the City's outstanding limited tax general obligation bonds and pay the costs of issuance of the bonds; fixing or setting parameters with respect to certain terms and covenants of the bonds; appointing the City's designated representative to approve the final terms of the sale of the bonds; and providing for other related matters.

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVED TO ADOPT ORDINANCE NO. 843..
SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER. VOICE VOTE WAS
TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None.

NEW BUSINESS

None.

REPORTS BY THE CITY MANAGER

City Manager Russell reported that a review of 4th Quarter 2025 Police Report, Volunteer Program Update, Title 12 Code Amendments and fiber optic cable franchise with Clover Park School District will come forward at the City Council study session of February 9, 2026. He shared he is working to schedule meetings with the facilitator in advance of the Retreat. He also requested feedback from the City Council regarding availability to travel to Washington, D.C. during the weeks of April 27th, May 4th or May 11th to meet with the Federal Delegation.

He announced the following upcoming meetings and events:

- February 4, 5:15 P.M., Public Safety Advisory Committee, Lakewood Police Station

- February 10, 6:30 P.M., Tillicum Community Association, Tillicum Community Center
- February 12, 7:00 P.M., Lake City Neighborhood Association, Fire Station 22
- February 15, 3 P.M., Vibrant Schools Black History Month Celebration, Lakes High School

CITY COUNCIL COMMENTS

Councilmember Talbo shared that she attended the Parks and Recreation Advisory Board meeting, visited Wards Lake Park to view recent improvements and spoke about the Emerson Lake Project. She requested a future City Council discussion around engagement with residents.

Councilmember Brandstetter shared that he will attend the Washington-Tacoma Korean Association Korea Day Celebration and he will be absent from the March 2nd Council meeting.

Councilmember Lindholm shared that he will attend the Washington-Tacoma Korean Association Korea Day Celebration and requested the City Council consider signing up for attendance at neighborhood association meetings rather than being assigned.

Councilmember Lauricella spoke about the significance of the Oak tree in the Woodbrook neighborhood and shared that this week he will attend the Public Safety Advisory Committee meeting. He reported that he will be absent from the February 9th Council meeting.

Councilmember Pearson shared that he attended the Puget Sound Regional Council meeting where there was discussion regarding significant jobs lost in Washington State.

Deputy Mayor Belle shared that she attended the Association of Washington Cities (AWC) City Action Days, shared that she looks forward to the Volunteer Program Update and encouraged Councilmembers to attend a Youth Council meeting to engage with students.

Mayor Bocchi shared that Representative Leavitt will be hosting Tele Town Hall on Tuesday and he spoke about long term impacts of job losses across the state, environmental preservation and considering opportunities through Conservation Futures.

ADJOURNMENT

There being no further business, the meeting adjourned at 9:05 p.m.



PAUL BOCCHI, MAYOR

ATTEST:



BRIANA SCHUMACHER
CITY CLERK